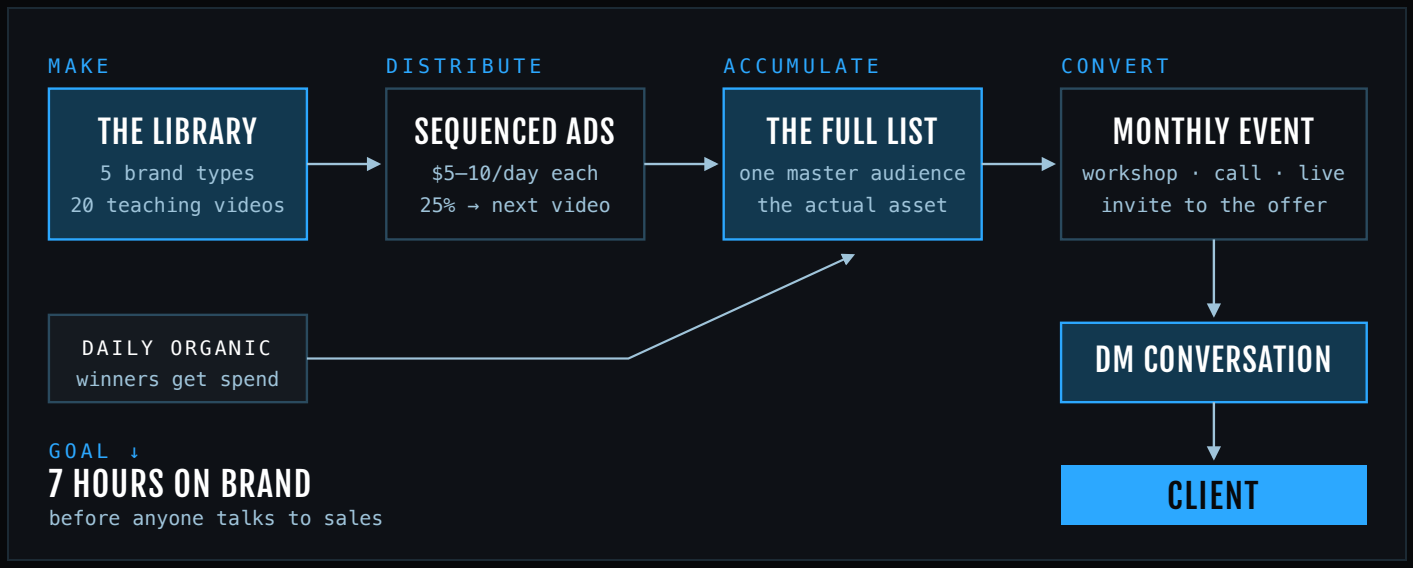
↑ LESSONS AND WORKSHEETS IN ONE BOOK

BUILD THE MACHINE

Twenty-six weekly lessons, each followed immediately by the worksheet that produces its deliverable. One book. Read the lesson, do the work, fill the sheet, clear the gate.

FIG. 00 — THE MACHINE AT A GLANCE



HOW THIS BOOK WORKS

Every week gives you why it matters, the lesson, the tasks, the deliverable, and a **Done when** test. Directly beneath it sits the worksheet that produces that deliverable. Nothing to cross-reference.

Panels marked ◆ **Worked example** follow one fictional company — a basement waterproofing contractor — through the whole build. Weeks marked ◆ **Phase gate** stop you: do not start the next phase until that deliverable exists. Weeks marked ↺ **Reuse** use sheets you have already met.

Figures marked ▣ are the reference diagrams from the system manual, placed at the week they explain. **Pace on the gate, not the calendar.** A week that takes three weeks is normal. Only the *Done when* line decides whether you advance — a full worksheet with weak answers is still a failed week, which is what the rubrics are for.

TASKS COMPLETE	0 / 118

WORKSHEET FIELDS	0 / 371

THE FIVE PHASES

01 · W1–4	02 · W5–8	03 · W9–18	04 · W19–22	05 · W23–26
Foundation	Raw material	Production	Distribution	Conversion

Twenty-six weeks is the fast path with a focused operator. Six to nine months is common and completely fine. What is not fine is running phases in parallel.

PHASE 01 W1–W4

FOUNDATION

WHAT YOU SAY

Messaging is the only work that makes every later week cheaper. Nothing gets filmed until these answers exist on paper.

W01 THE ONLY METRIC THAT MATTERS

PHASE 01

Before any work happens, everyone involved has to agree on what success looks like — or the first slow month kills the whole effort.

THE LESSON

- Read section 00 of the handoff manual. The benchmark is roughly seven hours of consumed content, eleven interactions, four locations before a purchase decision.
- Reframe: you are not buying leads, you are buying accumulated attention. Leads are the byproduct.
- Every metric you have reported on before — impressions, followers, cost per lead — is a proxy. Time on brand is the thing itself.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Audit what you publish today: how many minutes of content can one prospect actually consume about you right now?
- [ ] Write the number down. Most businesses find it is under twelve minutes.
- [ ] Name the person accountable for this system and the hour per day they own.
- [ ] Agree in writing that months 1–4 will produce no measurable leads, and that is expected.

DELIVERABLE

A one-page starting audit: current minutes available, current audience size, named owner, agreed 12-month horizon.

DONE WHEN

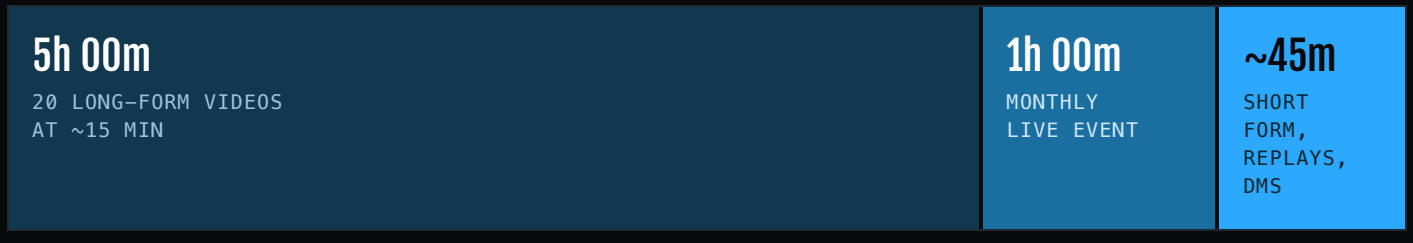
You can state your current time-on-brand number and nobody on the team expects leads before month five.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *If a prospect wanted to spend seven hours with your brand this week, could they? What exists?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Skipping this week. Teams that never agreed on the metric abandon the system in month three when leads have not moved.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 01 — HOW 7 HOURS ACCUMULATES



↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK

MODULE 01

01 STARTING AUDIT

W1

Where you actually stand today. You compare against these numbers in module 19.

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

A FILLED AUDIT

MINUTES AVAILABLE	9 minutes — one 2-min promo, three 90-sec FAQ clips, a 3-min testimonial
AUDIENCE SIZE	1,340 followers, no retargeting audience, 210-person email list
OWNER	Ray (owner) on camera · Dana (ops) owns publishing
HOURS / WEEK	Ray 3, Dana 5
NOT EXPECTING	No change in booked jobs before month five. Reviewed at month 5, not before.

MINUTES OF CONTENT A PROSPECT CAN CONSUME ABOUT YOU TODAY

e.g. 9 minutes

CURRENT AUDIENCE / LIST SIZE

NAMED OWNER OF THIS SYSTEM

HOURS PER WEEK THEY OWN FOR IT

WHAT WE AGREE NOT TO EXPECT (AND UNTIL WHEN)

No measurable lead change before month five.

W02 MESSAGING: TRANSFORMATION, TENSION, SHIFT

PHASE 01

Questions 01–03 define who you are talking to and what changes for them. Everything downstream is a restatement of these three.

THE LESSON

- Q1 — What do you do? Answer without naming the industry, product, or service. If the product must appear, put it last.
- Q2 — What is your customer frustrated, overwhelmed, or sick and tired of? Answer each of those words separately. Frustrated is not the same as sick and tired.
- Q3 — What do you increase, reduce, improve, simplify, or optimize? Again, one answer per verb. Five separate lines.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Draft Q1 in one sentence. Rewrite it four times, each shorter than the last.
- [ ] Write the three separate answers to Q2 — frustrated / overwhelmed / sick and tired.
- [ ] Write the five separate answers to Q3 — increase / reduce / improve / simplify / optimize.
- [ ] Read the Q2 answers to two actual customers. Change the words to match what they say back.

DELIVERABLE

Core Transformation (one sentence), Core Tension (three answers), Core Shift (five answers).

DONE WHEN

A stranger reading only these can describe who you help and what changes — without knowing your industry.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
>
> *Which of your Q3 answers can you put a number on? Those become your proof points later.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Answering Q2 and Q3 as one blended paragraph. The separation is the point — each verb produces a different video.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 02 — THE ONE-PAGE MESSAGING CANVAS — FILL THIS IN

01 · WHAT DO YOU DO?

CORE TRANSFORMATION

02 · WHAT ARE THEY SICK OF?

CORE TENSION

FRUSTRATED BY

OVERWHELMED BY

SICK AND TIRED OF

03 · WHAT DO YOU IMPROVE?

CORE SHIFT

INCREASE

REDUCE

IMPROVE

SIMPLIFY

OPTIMIZE

04 · WHAT MUST THEY BELIEVE?

CORE BELIEF

05 · WHAT STORY INSTALLS IT?

CORE STORY

06 · THE NAME OR HOOK

CORE HOOK

07 · THE ACRONYM / METHOD

CORE MECHANISM

> Print this page. Write in sentences. When all seven boxes are full, you can script anything in this document without a blank page.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 02

02 THE SEVEN MESSAGING QUESTIONS

W2–W4

The one page everything else is built from. Answer each sub-prompt separately — do not blend them.

Q1 · CORE TRANSFORMATION — WHAT DO YOU DO?

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

Q1, AFTER FOUR REWRITES

DRAFT 1	We waterproof residential basements in the Lehigh Valley.
DRAFT 4	We give people back the bottom third of their house — permanently, and without them having to become an expert in water.

NO INDUSTRY, PRODUCT, OR SERVICE NAME. IF THE PRODUCT MUST APPEAR, PUT IT LAST.

Q2 · CORE TENSION — THREE SEPARATE ANSWERS

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

THREE DISTINCT ANSWERS, NOT ONE BLENDED ONE

FRUSTRATED BY	Three contractors gave three different diagnoses and two of them blamed the gutters.
OVERWHELMED BY	Not knowing whether this is a $900 problem or a $19,000 problem until someone is in the basement.
SICK AND TIRED OF	Mopping after every heavy rain and pretending the smell is normal.

FRUSTRATED BY…

OVERWHELMED BY…

SICK AND TIRED OF…

Q3 · CORE SHIFT — FIVE SEPARATE ANSWERS

WE INCREASE…

WE REDUCE…

WE IMPROVE…

WE SIMPLIFY…

WE OPTIMIZE…

Q4 · CORE BELIEF

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

TEN CANDIDATES CUT TO ONE

CUT	"Quality matters." — a company claim, not a belief.
CUT	"Cheap waterproofing is expensive." — true but generic.
KEPT	Water in a basement is never a basement problem — it is a water-management problem, and anyone fixing only the basement will be back.

THE ONE IDEA THAT, ONCE ACCEPTED, MAKES BUYING OBVIOUS.

Q5 · CORE STORY

THE STORY THAT PROVES THE BELIEF INSTEAD OF ASSERTING IT.

Q6 · CORE HOOK

THE PHRASE A STRANGER COULD REPEAT BACK TO YOU

Q7 · CORE MECHANISM

YOUR NAMED PROCESS / ACRONYM

STAGE 1

STAGE 2

STAGE 3

STAGE 4 (OPTIONAL)

STAGE 5 (OPTIONAL)

MESSAGING PAGE — WEAK / ACCEPTABLE / STRONG

CRITERION	WEAK	ACCEPTABLE	STRONG
TRANSFORMATION	Names the service	Describes an outcome	Describes a specific identity or business change
TENSION	Generic pain	Recognizable pain	Uses exact customer language, verbatim
SHIFT	One vague claim	Some verbs answered	All five answered, at least two with numbers
BELIEF	A company claim	A useful idea	Makes buying logically obvious once accepted
STORY	Summarized	Told with a result	Told with tension, specifics, and a clear point
HOOK	Descriptive	Memorable	Strangers repeat it back unprompted
MECHANISM	Service steps	A named process	Memorable, defensible, easy to refer

W03 MESSAGING: BELIEF AND STORY

PHASE 01

Q4 is the highest-leverage sentence in the entire system. Every piece of content you publish either installs the core belief or wastes the slot.

THE LESSON

- Q4 — What must your customer believe to make your offer a no-brainer? One idea. Not three.
- Q5 — What story installs that belief? Belief cannot be asserted; it has to be demonstrated.
- A belief you have to argue for is the wrong belief. The right one is obvious once seen.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Write ten candidate core beliefs. Cut to three. Cut to one.
- [ ] Test the survivor: if a prospect accepted this as true, would buying become obvious? If not, keep cutting.
- [ ] Write the story that proves it — what happened, to whom, and what changed.
- [ ] Tell that story out loud to someone unfamiliar with the business. Watch where they lean in and where they drift.

DELIVERABLE

Core Belief (one sentence) and Core Story (200–400 words, told not summarized).

DONE WHEN

You can say the belief in under ten seconds and back it with a story you do not need notes for.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
>
> *What does your best customer believe that your worst prospect does not?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Choosing a belief that flatters you instead of one that reframes them.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Continue module 02 — Q4 and Q5.

W04 MESSAGING: HOOK AND MECHANISM

◆ PHASE GATE

Q6 and Q7 make the message portable. A named hook travels by word of mouth; a named mechanism turns a service into a method people trust and refer.

THE LESSON

- Q6 — Is there a clever name or hook that defines you? If strangers can repeat it, it works.
- Q7 — Is there an acronym or named sequence that makes your process easy to understand?
- A method is what people refer. Nobody refers a service description.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Brainstorm twenty hooks. Say each one out loud. Keep the three you are not embarrassed by.
- [ ] Name your process — three to five stages, ideally spelling something.
- [ ] Assemble all seven answers onto one page. This page never leaves your desk.
- [ ] Read the page to a customer and a stranger. Note every sentence that needed explaining, and rewrite it.

DELIVERABLE

The one-page messaging document — all seven answers, final.

DONE WHEN

Two people outside the company can read the page and correctly explain what you do, who it is for, and why it works.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *If a customer described you to a friend, which of your seven answers would they actually use?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Forcing an acronym that does not fit. A clear three-stage name beats a tortured five-letter one.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 03 — MESSAGING ALIGNMENT: WHICH INPUT EACH VIDEO TYPE NEEDS

QUESTION	INPUT	DOC.	PROD.	PROOF	OWNER.	EXPERT
What do you really do?	CORE TRANSFORMATION	●	●	·	●	●
What are they sick of?	CORE TENSION	●	●	●	●	●
What do you improve?	CORE SHIFT	●	●	●	●	●
What must they believe?	CORE BELIEF	●	●	●	●	●
What story installs it?	CORE STORY	●	·	●	·	●
Why don't they believe it yet?	CORE OBJECTION	·	●	●	●	●
What myth keeps them stuck?	CORE ILLUSION	·	●	·	·	●
What proves the method works?	CORE PROOF	●	●	●	●	●

> Read a column to know what a video needs before you write it. Read a row to see how far one answer travels.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 03

03 SECONDARY PRODUCTION INPUTS

W4 · AFTER THE SEVEN

Three additional inputs the product, proof, ownership and expert videos need. These are not new questions — they are extracted from the seven once those are settled.

> You can finish the seven questions correctly and still lack these. Fill them before scripting anything in section C.

CORE OBJECTION

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

"The last company gave a lifetime warranty too, and they are out of business." — every proof and ownership video answers this one.

THE REAL REASON A QUALIFIED BUYER HESITATES — THE ONE THEY SAY OUT LOUD ON CALL THREE, NOT CALL ONE.

CORE ILLUSION

THE INDUSTRY MYTH OR COMMON FIX THAT KEEPS THEM STUCK. THIS IS WHAT THE ILLUMINATE STAGE DISMANTLES.

CORE PROOF

THE SINGLE STRONGEST PIECE OF EVIDENCE YOU OWN — A NUMBER, A CASE, A DEMONSTRATION, A GUARANTEE THAT COSTS YOU SOMETHING.

WHERE EACH OF THESE IS CURRENTLY DOCUMENTED

So writers can find them without asking

PHASE 02 W5–W8

RAW MATERIAL

WHAT YOU SAY IT WITH

Stories and a topic matrix. By the end you have twenty titles and eight told stories — the blank page problem is solved permanently.

W05 HARVEST THE STORY BANK

PHASE 02

Stories are the only content that never goes stale. This week is collection, not writing — quantity first.

THE LESSON

- Six sources: origin moments, customer transformations, failures and what they taught, industry moments that made you angry, everyday jobs that went sideways, and things you changed your mind about.
- A usable story has tension. A job that went perfectly is not a story.
- You are hunting for twenty candidates, not eight finished pieces.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Set a timer for 45 minutes and list every story you can remember, one line each. Do not evaluate.
- [ ] Go through the last twelve months of jobs, projects, or clients and add any with tension.
- [ ] Ask two long-tenured people for the stories they tell when explaining the business.
- [ ] Score each candidate 1–5 on tension, on proof value, and on how easily you can tell it.

DELIVERABLE

A story bank list of 15–20 candidates with scores.

DONE WHEN

You have at least fifteen candidates and can name your top eight.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *What story do you already tell on every sales call without meaning to? That is story one.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Only collecting flattering stories. The failures convert better.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 08 — THE CAPTURE PROCESS

01 · CAPTURE
The moment something happens — a call, a job, a complaint, an offhand remark — it goes into one running list. Two sentences is enough.

02 · LOG
Once a week, each entry gets a name and a tag: the belief it changes and the topic it belongs to.

03 · SHARPEN
Write the story to three lengths: 20 seconds, 90 seconds, 3 minutes — matching the three cuts in section 04. Same story, different resolution.

04 · ASSIGN
Attach each story to specific videos in the matrix. A story with no assignment isn't finished.

FIG. 09 — A COMPLETED ENTRY

"THE FLOODED BASEMENT"

EXAMPLE · ROCK BOTTOM

BELIEF IT CHANGES	"Cheapest bid" and "best value" are not the same number.
THE TURN	A homeowner took a bid $4k under ours. Two winters later we pulled out the whole system and did it twice — at their cost, in February.
TOPIC & ANGLE	Topic 2 · analytical, and again as aspirational
ASSIGNED TO	Video 06 (Illuminate) · reel #14 · VSL dimension 06
LENGTHS	20s ✓ · 90s ✓ · 3 min drafted
CLEARANCE	Anonymized — no street name, no photos of the house

Copy this shape. A story is finished when every row is filled — especially the last two.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 04

04 STORY BANK CAPTURE

W5

Twenty candidates, one line each. Collect first, judge later. Score 1–5 on tension, proof value, and ease of telling.

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

TWO CAPTURED LINES

01 · 5/5/5	Flooded basement, night before a closing — we pumped it at 2am and found the real source was the neighbor's regrade.	
02 · 4/5/2	Customer who had paid twice before us; needed permission and is still emotional about it.	

01	One line — what happened	T/P/E
02	One line — what happened	T/P/E
03	One line — what happened	T/P/E
04	One line — what happened	T/P/E
05	One line — what happened	T/P/E
06	One line — what happened	T/P/E
07	One line — what happened	T/P/E
08	One line — what happened	T/P/E
09	One line — what happened	T/P/E
10	One line — what happened	T/P/E
11	One line — what happened	T/P/E
12	One line — what happened	T/P/E
13	One line — what happened	T/P/E
14	One line — what happened	T/P/E
15	One line — what happened	T/P/E

16	One line — what happened	T/P/E
17	One line — what happened	T/P/E
18	One line — what happened	T/P/E
19	One line — what happened	T/P/E
20	One line — what happened	T/P/E

W06 SHAPE THE TOP EIGHT STORIES

PHASE 02

A raw memory is not usable content. Each story needs a fixed shape so it can be dropped into any video, email, or talk without rewriting.

THE LESSON

- Every story gets the same five parts: the situation, the tension, the turn, the result, and the point.
- The point is what links the story to a messaging answer. A story with no point is an anecdote.
- One story can serve several points depending on where you stop.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Write your top eight stories in the five-part shape, 150–300 words each.
- [ ] Tag each story with the messaging answers it supports — belief, tension, shift, or proof.
- [ ] Mark which stories need permission, footage, photos, or a customer on camera.
- [ ] Put the bank somewhere the whole team can add to it.

DELIVERABLE
Eight written stories, tagged and stored in a shared location.

DONE WHEN
You can pull a story for any of the seven messaging answers in under a minute.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *Which single story, if told well on camera, would do the most work for you?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Polishing stories into press releases. Keep the specific, awkward, human details.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 10 — WHAT EACH ENTRY RECORDS

FIELD	WHAT GOES IN IT
NAME	A short handle that is easy to say out loud — "the flooded basement," "the Tuesday callback."
BELIEF IT CHANGES	The one thing a viewer thinks differently after hearing it. If you can't name this, it's an anecdote, not a story.
THE TURN	The moment it goes wrong, and the moment it resolves. Drama plus overcoming.
TOPIC & ANGLE	Which of the five topics it serves, and which angle it fits best.
ASSIGNED TO	The specific videos, cuts, and VSL dimensions using it. Track reuse on purpose.
CLEARANCE	Whether the customer approved being named, and any detail that has to change.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 05

05 FULL STORY RECORD

W6 · ONE PER STORY

One sheet per story. Duplicate this eight times. A story is not usable until every field below is filled — including the three lengths and the clearance line.

STORY TITLE / SHORTHAND

The Flooded Basement

BELIEF IT INSTALLS

Which of your messaging answers this proves

TOPIC AND ANGLE

From the module 06 matrix

1 · THE SITUATION — WHO, WHEN, WHAT WAS NORMAL

2 · THE TENSION — WHAT WENT WRONG OR WHAT WAS AT STAKE

3 · THE TURN — WHAT CHANGED, WHAT WAS DECIDED

4 · THE RESULT — SPECIFIC, WITH NUMBERS WHERE POSSIBLE

5 · THE POINT — THE BELIEF THIS INSTALLS

THE THREE LENGTHS

20-SECOND VERSION — SHORT FORM, ONE BEAT

90-SECOND VERSION — THE STANDARD TELLING

3-MINUTE VERSION — FULL, FOR LONG FORM AND THE VSL

ASSIGNMENT AND CLEARANCE

ASSIGNED TO WHICH ASSETS

e.g. Documentary · Expert #4 · VSL dimension 08

CLEARANCE STATUS

Written permission / anonymized / needs release / cleared

WHERE PERMISSION IS STORED

ASSETS NEEDED

Footage / photos / customer on camera

W07 FIVE TOPICS, TWENTY VIDEOS

PHASE 02

The matrix removes the question "what should I make this week" permanently. Five customer problems, four teaching angles, twenty titles.

THE LESSON

- Pick the five biggest beliefs, problems, or misconceptions your ideal customer holds. One topic each.
- Teach every topic four ways: actionable (how), analytical (why), psychological (what stops people), aspirational (what becomes possible).
- Twenty cells, twenty long-form videos, decided once.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Name the five topics. Pull them from your Q2 and Q4 answers, not from keyword tools.
- [ ] Fill all twenty cells with actual working titles, not themes.
- [ ] Assign each title an angle and a story from the bank.
- [ ] Sequence the twenty by which would matter most to someone who knows nothing about you.

DELIVERABLE

A filled 5 × 4 matrix — twenty titles, each with an angle and a story attached.

DONE WHEN

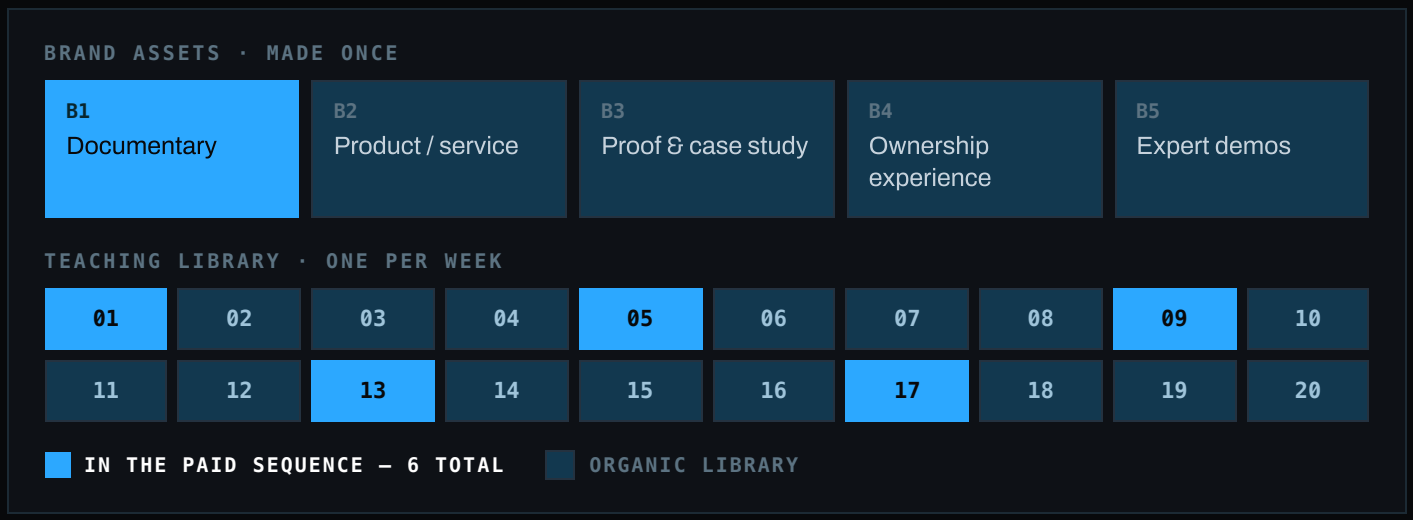
Every cell has a title you could film tomorrow without further thinking.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
>
> *Which of the twenty are you avoiding because it is hard to say? Move it earlier.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Writing topic labels instead of titles. "Pricing" is not a video; "Why the cheapest quote costs you the most" is.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 04 — THE 25-VIDEO LIBRARY, AND THE SIX THAT CARRY AD SPEND



> The documentary plus one teaching video per topic form the ad ladder in section 06. Everything else earns its way in by out-performing one of the six.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 06

06 TOPIC MATRIX + ASSIGNMENTS

W7

Five customer problems, four teaching angles, twenty titles — each with the story, belief, and funnel role attached. A title with no story attached is not ready to film.

THE FIVE TOPICS

TOPIC 1

TOPIC 2

TOPIC 3

TOPIC 4

TOPIC 5

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

ONE COMPLETED CELL

TITLE	Why the cheapest waterproofing quote is the one that costs you twice
ANGLE	Analytical — why
STORY	#02, the customer who paid twice
BELIEF	Water is a water-management problem
OBJECTION	"They all promise a lifetime warranty"
FUNNEL ROLE	Mid — sequence step 3
AD CANDIDATE	Yes
CTA	Shift magnet — the 9-point drainage audit

THE TWENTY TITLES

TOPIC 1

ACTIONABLE

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ANALYTICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ASPIRATIONAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

TOPIC 2

ACTIONABLE

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ANALYTICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ASPIRATIONAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

TOPIC 3

ACTIONABLE

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ANALYTICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ASPIRATIONAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

TOPIC 4

ACTIONABLE

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ANALYTICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ASPIRATIONAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

TOPIC 5

ACTIONABLE

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ANALYTICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

PSYCHOLOGICAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

ASPIRATIONAL

Working title

Story # | Funnel role | Publish order

W08 LEARN S.H.I.F.T. · SCRIPT ONE VIDEO

◆ PHASE GATE

One structure runs every video in the library. Learning it once means you never stare at a blank page again.

THE LESSON

- Signal — earn attention. Humanize — earn trust. Illuminate — reveal what they misunderstand. Formulate — show the better way. Transfer — one clear next action.
- The five stages never change. Only the language changes between video types.
- A script is the five stages with your messaging answers and one story dropped in.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Read the S.H.I.F.T. section and the five type-specific frameworks in the handoff manual.
- [ ] Pick the easiest of your twenty titles and script it fully against the five stages.
- [ ] Read it out loud with a timer. Cut anything that does not serve a stage.
- [ ] Script two more so you have a rhythm before production week.

DELIVERABLE

Three finished scripts and a reusable script template.

DONE WHEN

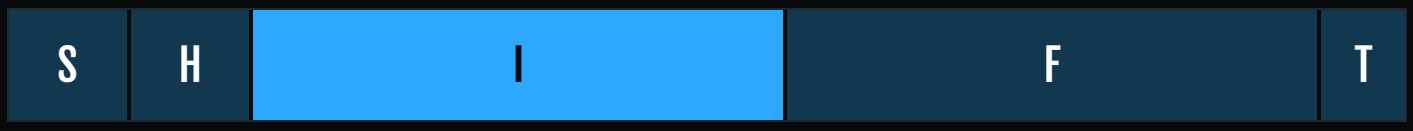
You can write a full script in under 90 minutes without agonizing over structure.

> COACHING PROMPT
> *Where in your current sales conversation do you already run S.H.I.F.T. without realizing it?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Over-scripting. Write to the structure, then speak like a person.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 05 — WHERE THE THREE MINUTES GO



0:00–0:15	0:15–0:30	0:30–1:45	1:45–3:00	3:00–3:10
Snag & Swear	Harness & Highlight	Illuminate the Illusion	Formulate the Fix	Trigger the Transfer

> Illuminate and Formulate are 40% of the runtime each. Hook and CTA together are under 15%. If your script is front-loaded with hook and pitch, it is not this structure.

FIG. 06 — PRODUCTION GUIDE: FIVE TAKES

TAKE	TIME	CAMERA & EDITING	VIBE
TAKE 1 · S	0:00 – 0:15	Tight & direct: center frame, close-up. Fast text hooks on screen. No distractions.	High energy, disruptive
TAKE 2 · H	0:15 – 0:30	The pivot angle: shift the camera 30°, or step back to a medium shot. Pop-up graphic for the comment word.	Conversational, settling in
TAKE 3 · I	0:30 – 1:45	The "real talk" shot: steady, slightly wider. Overlay B-roll and punch cuts to emphasize the pain.	Empathetic but authoritative
TAKE 4 · F	1:45 – 3:00	The teaching angle: a brand-new visual setting — whiteboard, desk, heavy graphics or green screen for the 3 steps.	Educational, clear, structured
TAKE 5 · T	3:00 – 3:10	The urgent close-up: punch way back in. Center frame, pointing at the camera or down at the caption.	Urgent and directive

FIG. 07 — UNIVERSAL S.H.I.F.T. LOGIC

STAGE	UNIVERSAL FUNCTION	QUESTION IT MUST ANSWER
S SIGNAL	Capture attention through relevance, tension, aspiration, or story	Why should I keep watching?
H HUMANIZE	Create trust, identification, credibility, or emotional investment	Why should I care, or trust you?
I ILLUMINATE	Reveal the conflict, hidden cause, false belief, or turning point	What have I misunderstood?
F FORMULATE	Present the mechanism, process, transformation, or resolution	How does the better path work?
T TRANSFER	Move belief, value, or momentum into one next action	What should I do now?

↓ WORKSHEETS FOR THIS WEEK — MODULES 07 · 08

07 S.H.I.F.T. — UNIVERSAL TO TYPE-SPECIFIC

W8 · READ ONCE

One backbone, five expressions. These are not competing frameworks. Read down for the stage, across for the language that stage uses in each video type.

UNIVERSAL	PURPOSE	DOC.	PRODUCT	PROOF	OWNER.	EXPERT
S SIGNAL	Earn attention	Spark the story	See the future	Share the struggle	Start the experience	Snag & swear
H HUMANIZE	Earn trust	Humanize the mission	Highlight the gap	Highlight the hesitation	Humanize the handoff	Harness & highlight
I ILLUMINATE	Reframe	Ignite the conflict	Introduce the mechanism	Identify the inflection	Illustrate the journey	Illuminate the illusion
F FORMULATE	Show the way	Forge the difference	Frame the journey	Finish the transformation	Fortify the trust	Formulate the fix
T TRANSFER	One action	Transfer the legacy	Take the first step	Tell them what's possible	Take the next step	Trigger the transfer

> The stage functions never change. If a type-specific label ever conflicts with the universal purpose, the universal purpose wins.

08 S.H.I.F.T. SCRIPT SHEET

EVERY VIDEO

One sheet per video. You will use this twenty-five times. Pull the type-specific language from module 07.

VIDEO TITLE

TYPE

Documentary / Product / Proof / Ownership / Expert

STORY PULLED FROM THE BANK

MESSAGING ANSWERS USED

Include objection and illusion where relevant

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

SIGNAL, EXPERT DEMONSTRATION

"If your sump pump runs after a dry week, you do not have a pump problem. In the next four minutes I am going to show you the two places that water is actually coming from — and which one you can check yourself tonight."

S · SIGNAL — EARN ATTENTION IN THE FIRST FIFTEEN SECONDS

H · HUMANIZE — EARN TRUST AND RELEVANCE

I · ILLUMINATE — REVEAL WHAT THEY HAVE MISUNDERSTOOD

F · FORMULATE — THE BETTER WAY, IN STEPS

T · TRANSFER — ONE CLEAR NEXT ACTION

PHASE 03 W9–W18

PRODUCTION

BUILDING THE LIBRARY

Twenty-five videos plus a VSL, shot in batches. This is the longest phase and the one people quit in. Ship rough over late.

W09 PRODUCTION SETUP

PHASE 03

Production friction is the single biggest cause of abandonment. Solve it once and the next ten weeks get easy.

THE LESSON

- You need one location, one lighting setup, one audio solution, and a repeatable routine. Nothing more.
- Batching is non-negotiable — you will film five to eight pieces per session, not one.
- Good audio beats good video. Fix sound first.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Choose and set up one filming location that can stay set up.
- [ ] Test lighting and audio, and record a two-minute sample. Watch it back.
- [ ] Decide who edits, on what turnaround, and where the files live.
- [ ] Book the next ten filming sessions in the calendar now, before anything else can claim the time.

DELIVERABLE

A permanent filming setup and ten booked sessions.

DONE WHEN

You can walk in, press record, and be filming within five minutes.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *What is the one thing that will make you skip a filming day? Remove it this week.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Buying gear instead of booking sessions. Constraint produces volume; equipment does not.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 09

09 PRODUCTION SETUP

W9 · ONCE

Solve friction once and the next ten weeks get easy. Everything on this page should stay set up permanently.

FILMING LOCATION

CAN IT STAY SET UP?

Yes / no — if no, what is the 5-minute setup routine

CAMERA + SETTINGS

AUDIO SOLUTION

AUDIO TEST RESULT

Listen back on phone speakers, not headphones

LIGHTING SETUP — DESCRIBE OR SKETCH SO ANYONE CAN REBUILD IT

FILE NAMING STANDARD

e.g. MCM-EXP-014-v2

STORAGE LOCATION — RAW

STORAGE LOCATION — FINALS

EDITOR

TURNAROUND SLA

Days from footage delivered to rough cut

BACKUP PLAN WHEN THE SHOOT DAY FAILS

TEN BOOKED FILMING DATES

01	Date + what gets filmed	02	Date + what gets filmed
03	Date + what gets filmed	04	Date + what gets filmed
05	Date + what gets filmed	06	Date + what gets filmed
07	Date + what gets filmed	08	Date + what gets filmed
09	Date + what gets filmed	10	Date + what gets filmed

> If these ten dates are not in the shared calendar with the talent accepted, this module is not complete.

W10 FILM THE BRAND DOCUMENTARY

PHASE 03

The documentary earns emotional trust and does work no other asset can. It is also the hardest, so it goes first while energy is high.

THE LESSON

- Structure: spark the story, humanize the mission, ignite the conflict, forge the difference, transfer the legacy.
- Do not flinch from the drama. If a painful episode pushed you into this work, that is the film.
- Introduce the people and what each of them protects.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script against the documentary framework using your Core Story.
- [ ] Film the founder interview, the team pieces, and enough b-roll of real work.
- [ ] Cut to 4–8 minutes. Resist making it longer.
- [ ] Show it to three customers before publishing and note where attention drops.

DELIVERABLE
One finished brand documentary.

DONE WHEN
Someone who has never heard of you watches it through and can say why you exist.

> COACHING PROMPT
> *What is the moment in your history you would rather not talk about? That is probably the opening.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Making a corporate overview. If it could be any company in your industry, start over.

↓ WORKSHEETS FOR THIS WEEK — MODULES 10 · 11 · 12

10 SHOOT BRIEF

ONE PER FILMING DAY

Filled the day before, not the morning of. Every unanswered field here becomes a delay on set.

SHOOT DATE

CALL TIME / WRAP TIME

VIDEOS BEING FILMED TODAY (TITLES + IDS)

SCRIPTS APPROVED BY

Name + date

TALENT ON CAMERA

WARDROBE NOTE

Continuity across the batch

LOCATION

PROPS / EQUIPMENT NEEDED

B-ROLL SHOT LIST

CUSTOMER PERMISSIONS NEEDED / OBTAINED

ESTIMATED RUNTIME PER PIECE

CTA FOR EACH PIECE

FOOTAGE DELIVERED TO EDITOR BY

ROUGH CUT DUE

11 EDITING QA

BEFORE EVERY PUBLISH

The editor or the owner runs this before anything leaves the folder. Any unchecked box sends it back.

CONTENT

- [ ] First fifteen seconds earn attention without a logo or an introduction
- [ ] One primary idea — nothing bundled in
- [ ] The story clearly supports the belief
- [ ] No unnecessary company introduction anywhere
- [ ] Nothing withheld to manufacture curiosity

CRAFT

- [ ] Audio is clean on phone speakers
- [ ] Captions present and checked for names and jargon
- [ ] B-roll supports the point rather than decorating
- [ ] No dead air longer than two seconds

DELIVERY

- [ ] CTA contains exactly one action
- [ ] Correct aspect ratios exported
- [ ] File named to the module 09 standard
- [ ] Thumbnail and title approved
- [ ] Stored in the finals location

12 PUBLISHING QA

EVERY PUBLISH

Publishing is where finished work quietly dies in a folder. One sheet per asset.

ASSET ID + TITLE

PLATFORM

PUBLISH DATE

DESCRIPTION COPY

THUMBNAIL APPROVED BY

CTA + LINK

TAGS

SUPPORTING ORGANIC POST SCHEDULED?

SUPPORTING EMAIL SCHEDULED?

AUDIENCE ASSIGNMENT

Which sequence step / which custom audience

PERFORMANCE REVIEW DATE

Two weeks out

↓ QUALITY STANDARD FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 13A

13A DOCUMENTARY QUALITY STANDARD

USE AT ROUGH CUT

Run this at rough cut, not after publishing.

BRAND DOCUMENTARY — WEAK / ACCEPTABLE / STRONG

CRITERION	WEAK	ACCEPTABLE	STRONG
OPENING	Company history in order	Starts on a moment	Starts on the moment you would rather not discuss
STAKES	States values	Names what is at risk	The viewer feels what would be lost
PEOPLE	Founder only	Founder + a name or two	Each person shown owns something specific
SPECIFICITY	Could be any company	Industry-specific	Could only be this company
LENGTH	Over 10 min	6–8 min	4–8 min with no section you could cut

W11 FILM THE PRODUCT OR SERVICE VIDEO

PHASE 03

This is the dream builder — the outcome first, the mechanism second. It carries most of your paid distribution.

THE LESSON

- Structure: see the future, highlight the gap, introduce the mechanism, frame the journey, take the first step.
- Lead with what life looks like after. The process is proof, not the pitch.
- Your named mechanism from Q7 lives here.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script against the product framework using Core Transformation and Core Shift.
- [ ] Film the outcome first — real results, real customers, real installations or deliverables.
- [ ] Film the process walkthrough as the supporting middle.
- [ ] Cut to 3–6 minutes with one clear next step at the end.

DELIVERABLE

One finished product or service video.

DONE WHEN

A viewer can describe the outcome you produce and roughly how you produce it.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *Are you describing features that only matter to you? Cut them and say what changes for them.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Opening with your process. Nobody cares how it works until they want what it produces.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse module 08 (script sheet), 10 (shoot brief), 11 (editing QA), 12 (publishing QA).

W12 FILM THE PROOF VIDEO

PHASE 03

Credibility transfers through a believable transformation told by someone other than you.

THE LESSON

- Structure: share the struggle, highlight the hesitation, identify the inflection point, finish the transformation, tell them what is possible.
- The hesitation section is what makes it believable. Ask what nearly stopped them from buying.
- Testimonial, case study, or narrated project walkthrough — pick whichever you can actually film this week.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Choose two customers whose situation matches your ideal prospect.
- [ ] Send questions in advance built on the five stages. Do not send a script.
- [ ] Film both, plus before-and-after evidence.
- [ ] Cut one strong 3–5 minute piece rather than two weak ones.

DELIVERABLE

At least one finished proof video with real numbers or visible before-and-after.

DONE WHEN

A skeptical prospect could watch it and recognize their own situation.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *Which objection does this customer answer just by existing? Feature that.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Editing out the doubts. The hesitation is the credibility.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse module 08 (script sheet), 10 (shoot brief), 11 (editing QA), 12 (publishing QA). The proof-video standard is module 13B, below.

↓ QUALITY STANDARD FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 13B

13B PROOF VIDEO QUALITY STANDARD

USE AT ROUGH CUT

Run this at rough cut, not after publishing.

PROOF VIDEO — WEAK / ACCEPTABLE / STRONG

CRITERION	WEAK	ACCEPTABLE	STRONG
SITUATION	Customer praises you	Problem stated	Problem stated in the customer's own words
HESITATION	Edited out	Mentioned	The near-miss reason they almost did not buy
EVIDENCE	Adjectives	A number	Before-and-after visible plus a number
OBJECTION	Unaddressed	Touched on	Directly answers the Core Objection from module 03
MATCH	Any customer	Similar customer	Mirrors the ideal prospect closely enough to be uncomfortable

W13 FILM THE OWNERSHIP EXPERIENCE VIDEO

PHASE 03

Almost nobody in your market makes this. It removes the fear of what happens after they say yes.

THE LESSON

- Structure: start the experience, humanize the handoff, illustrate the journey, fortify the trust, take the next step.
- Be specific with names and timeframes. "Dana calls you within the hour" beats "great communication".
- Address the unspoken worries — delays, quality, surprises, who to call.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Map every touchpoint from the moment someone says yes to completion.
- [ ] Film the actual people at the actual moments, in order.
- [ ] Include what happens when something goes wrong, and how you handle it.
- [ ] Cut to 3–5 minutes.

DELIVERABLE

One finished ownership experience video.

DONE WHEN

A prospect can picture the first week of working with you in specific detail.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *What do customers most often say they were nervous about beforehand? Answer it on camera.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Generic promises. Specificity is the entire value of this asset.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse modules 08, 10, 11, 12.

W14 EXPERT DEMONSTRATIONS · BATCH ONE

PHASE 03

The teaching library begins. Five videos per week for four weeks fills the matrix.

THE LESSON

- Structure: snag and swear, harness and highlight, illuminate the illusion, formulate the fix, trigger the transfer.
- Give away your best thinking. The reaction you want is: if this is free, what is it like to hire them?
- One video answers exactly one question. Do not bundle.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script five matrix titles against the expert demonstration framework.
- [ ] Film all five in one session.
- [ ] Publish the first one before the batch is fully edited — momentum over polish.
- [ ] Log which story from the bank each one used.

DELIVERABLE

Five long-form teaching videos, filmed.

DONE WHEN

Five of your twenty matrix cells are struck through.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
>
> *Which question do you answer on every sales call? Film that one first.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Withholding the answer to create curiosity. Teach fully; that is the whole strategy.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse modules 08, 10, 11, 12 — five times.

W15 EXPERT DEMONSTRATIONS · BATCH TWO

PHASE 03

Second batch. This is where the routine either becomes real or quietly dies.

THE LESSON

- By now the script template should cut prep time roughly in half.
- Watch batch one back before filming and fix one specific thing — pace, energy, or opening.
- Do not restart earlier videos. Improve forward.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script and film the next five matrix titles.
- [ ] Review batch one and write down the single habit to change.
- [ ] Confirm edits from batch one are published, not sitting in a folder.
- [ ] Update the matrix so progress is visible.

DELIVERABLE

Ten of twenty teaching videos filmed.

DONE WHEN

You are halfway through the matrix and filming feels routine.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *What took the longest this week? Systematize or delegate it before batch three.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Re-shooting early videos. Nobody is comparing them; you are.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse modules 08, 10, 11, 12 — five times.

W16 EXPERT DEMONSTRATIONS · BATCH THREE

PHASE 03

The middle of a long build. Nothing new to learn — just execution.

THE LESSON

- Consistency is now worth more than improvement.
- If a title from the matrix no longer feels right, replace it rather than skipping the slot.
- Keep a running list of new questions customers ask — that is next quarter's matrix.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script and film the next five matrix titles.
- [ ] Add any new customer questions to a "next matrix" list.
- [ ] Check that every filmed video has been published or scheduled.
- [ ] Note your accumulated library minutes.

DELIVERABLE

Fifteen of twenty teaching videos filmed.

DONE WHEN

Fifteen cells struck through and nothing sitting unedited for more than two weeks.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *How many minutes of you can a prospect now consume? Compare it to week one.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Letting edits pile up. Unpublished footage is worth nothing.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse modules 08, 10, 11, 12 — five times.

W17 EXPERT DEMONSTRATIONS · BATCH FOUR

PHASE 03

The library closes. This is the week the asset actually exists.

THE LESSON

- After this batch you have twenty-five videos — five brand assets and twenty teaching pieces.
- That is roughly five hours of consumable content, most of the seven-hour benchmark.
- Everything after this week is distribution, not production.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Script and film the final five matrix titles.
- [ ] Confirm all twenty-five videos are published and reachable in one place.
- [ ] Total the runtime. Write the number next to your week-one audit number.
- [ ] Archive all raw footage properly — it feeds short form for a year.

DELIVERABLE

A complete library of twenty-five published videos.

DONE WHEN

Every matrix cell is struck through and the full library is live somewhere a stranger can find it.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
>
> *What does your week-one audit number look like next to today's?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Celebrating and stopping. The library is the halfway point, not the finish.

↺ REUSE THIS WEEK

Reuse modules 08, 10, 11, 12 — five times.

W18 BUILD THE VSL

◆ PHASE GATE

The second CTA needs somewhere to send people who are ready now. A VSL is a complete argument, not a longer ad.

THE LESSON

- Thirteen dimensions in order: hook, big problem, founder story, discovery, unique mechanism, why others fail, your solution, proof, process, ownership experience, objections, future vision, CTA.
- You already have raw material for eleven of the thirteen from the library and the story bank.
- Length follows the dimensions, not a target runtime.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Draft all thirteen dimensions, pulling directly from existing scripts and stories.
- [ ] Read it aloud end to end and cut anything that repeats a previous dimension.
- [ ] Film and publish it on a page you control, not a social feed.
- [ ] Write the one action the CTA asks for. One only.

DELIVERABLE

A finished VSL on a page you control.

DONE WHEN

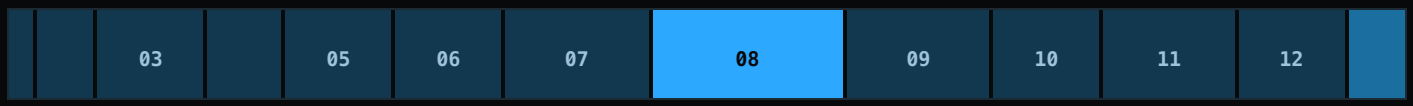
Someone who watches it end to end knows the problem, the mechanism, the proof, and exactly what to do next.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *Which dimension is weakest? That is usually proof — go get more.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Skipping objection handling. It is where most VSLs lose the ready buyer.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 17 — WHERE THE MINUTES GO IN A VSL



0:00 · HOOK — PROOF IS THE SINGLE BIGGEST BLOCK — ~12:40 · CTA

Mid-range timings across all thirteen dimensions. Proof, process, and the mechanism trio (05–07) carry more than half the runtime — the pitch itself is a thin slice.

FIG. 18 — DIMENSION REFERENCE

#	DIMENSION	CORE QUESTION	PURPOSE	LENGTH
01	HOOK	Why should I pay attention?	Interrupt attention and create curiosity.	5–15 sec
02	BIG PROBLEM	What problem am I facing?	Agitate the pain and establish relevance.	15–45 sec
03	FOUNDER STORY	Why should I trust you?	Humanize the brand and build connection.	30–90 sec
04	DISCOVERY	What changed your thinking?	Reveal the insight that led to your approach.	20–60 sec
05	UNIQUE MECHANISM	Why does your solution work differently?	Differentiate from commoditized alternatives.	30–90 sec
06	WHY OTHERS FAIL	Why haven't traditional methods worked?	Remove belief in alternatives and reframe the problem.	30–90 sec
07	YOUR SOLUTION	What do you actually do?	Introduce the offer and the transformation it provides.	45–120 sec
08	PROOF	Can you prove it?	Build credibility with testimonials, case studies, data, demos.	45–180 sec
09	PROCESS	How does it work?	Reduce uncertainty by explaining the customer journey.	45–120 sec
10	OWNERSHIP EXPERIENCE	What is it like to work with you?	Set expectations and reduce perceived risk.	30–90 sec
11	OBJECTION HANDLING	What's stopping me?	Address concerns before they harden into objections.	30–120 sec
12	FUTURE VISION	What happens if I say yes?	Let them imagine the outcome and the identity shift.	30–90 sec
13	STRONG CTA	What should I do next?	Give one clear, friction-free next step.	15–45 sec

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 18

18 VSL — THIRTEEN DIMENSIONS

W18

Draft each dimension in one or two sentences before writing the full script. Eleven of thirteen already exist in the library.

01 HOOK — WHY SHOULD I PAY ATTENTION?

02 BIG PROBLEM — WHAT AM I FACING?

03 FOUNDER STORY — WHY TRUST YOU?

04 DISCOVERY — WHAT CHANGED YOUR THINKING?

05 UNIQUE MECHANISM — WHY DOES THIS WORK DIFFERENTLY?

06 WHY OTHER SOLUTIONS FAIL

07 YOUR SOLUTION — WHAT DO YOU ACTUALLY DO?

08 PROOF — CAN YOU PROVE IT?

09 PROCESS — HOW DOES IT WORK?

10 OWNERSHIP EXPERIENCE — WHAT IS IT LIKE TO WORK WITH YOU?

11 OBJECTION HANDLING — WHAT IS STOPPING ME?

12 FUTURE VISION — WHAT HAPPENS IF I SAY YES?

13 STRONG CTA — ONE FRICTION-FREE NEXT STEP

VSL — WEAK / ACCEPTABLE / STRONG

CRITERION	WEAK	ACCEPTABLE	STRONG
HOOK	Introduces you	States a problem	Names a moment they had this week
MECHANISM	A process list	A named process	Explains why it structurally cannot fail the way others do
PROOF	Testimonial quotes	A case with numbers	Proof that would be expensive to fake
OBJECTIONS	Skipped	One handled	Every objection from module 03 answered before it forms
CTA	Several options	One action	One action, and the next five minutes are described

PHASE 04 W19—W22

DISTRIBUTION

GETTING IT IN FRONT OF PEOPLE

Sequenced ads, daily visibility, magnets and CTAs. The library is worthless until this phase is live.

W19 SET THE PUBLISHING RHYTHM

PHASE 04

Three cadences run simultaneously and are never negotiated: daily short form, weekly long form, monthly event.

THE LESSON

- Short form is made specifically, not cut out of long form. It can be inspired by a long-form idea, but it is its own piece.
- ShiftCycle gives the week its shape: Signal, Tension, Proof, Perspective, Path — Monday through Friday.
- ShiftTranslate takes one weekly theme and turns it into every asset the week needs.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Pick next week's single Shift theme from your matrix.
- [ ] Write the five daily pieces against the five stages — one per weekday.
- [ ] Schedule them. Then do the same for the following week.
- [ ] Decide who publishes daily and at what time, and put it in the calendar.

DELIVERABLE

Two full weeks of daily content scheduled, plus a named owner for daily publishing.

DONE WHEN

Content goes out for ten consecutive weekdays without anyone deciding what to post that morning.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *Which of the five daily stages do you find hardest to write? That is the one your messaging is weakest on.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Chopping long-form videos into clips and calling it short form. Different job, different piece.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 19 — THE FIVE SHIFTS

DAY	SHIFT STAGE	OBJECTIVE	EMOTION
MONDAY	SIGNAL	Attract aligned people	CURIOSITY
TUESDAY	TENSION	Agitate the real problem	FRUSTRATION
WEDNESDAY	PROOF	Build certainty	HOPE
THURSDAY	PERSPECTIVE	Replace the old worldview	CONVICTION
FRIDAY	PATH	Make action inevitable	MOMENTUM

FIG. 20 — A NORMAL WEEK, MAPPED TO THE SHIFTCYCLE™

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
SIGNAL	**TENSION**	**PROOF**	**PERSPECTIVE**	**PATH**	Dark · scheduled posts only	Review numbers · log stories · pick next winner to promote
Long form publishes on the week's theme · short form that names who this is for	Short form that agitates the real problem behind the theme	Short form proof — a result, a demo, a story from the bank	Short form that replaces the old worldview with the new frame	Short form that makes the next step obvious · next week's long form filmed		
CURIOSITY	FRUSTRATION	HOPE	CONVICTION	MOMENTUM		

FIG. 21 — ONE THEME, FIFTEEN ASSETS

WEEKLY SHIFT THEME — THE ONE INSIGHT

↓ BUILT FOR EACH FORMAT

01 Long-form email	02 YouTube video	03 Podcast	04 LinkedIn post	05 X thread
06 Carousel	07 Instagram reel	08 TikTok	09 Quote graphics	10 Blog post
11 Lead magnet	12 Sales page updates	13 Cold outreach hooks	14 Ads	15 Future case studies

> One insight. One transformation. One week's worth of content — fifteen surfaces, all pointing at the same shift.

FIG. 22 — FIVE MOVES, IN ORDER

01 PICK ONE THING

One observation. One mistake. One client. One lesson. One analogy.

NOTHING ELSE. AN EMAIL WITH TWO IDEAS HAS NONE.

↓

02 TELL THE STORY

What happened? Keep it concrete — names, numbers, weather, the room.

NO SETUP, NO PREAMBLE. START INSIDE THE MOMENT.

↓

03 REVEAL THE SHIFT

Why did it matter? What is the hidden lesson underneath the anecdote?

THIS IS THE SENTENCE PEOPLE FORWARD.

↓

04 RELATE IT BACK

"This is exactly what happens when..." · "This is why most businesses..." · "This reminded me..."

MOVE IT FROM YOUR STORY TO THEIR SITUATION IN ONE LINE.

↓

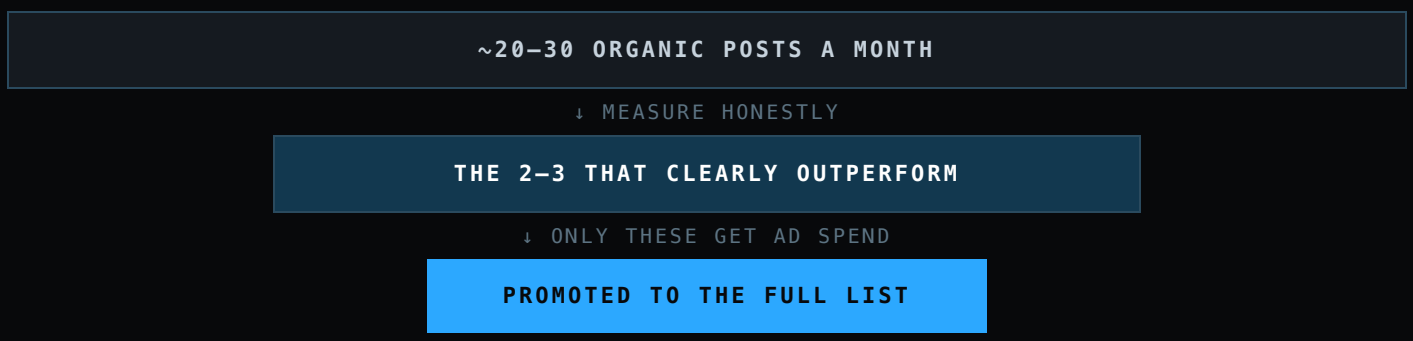
05 ONE CTA

Reply · read · watch · book · download · think · share.

PICK ONE VERB. THINKING AND REPLYING COUNT — EVERY EMAIL DOES NOT NEED TO SELL.

> Same spine as S.H.I.F.T., compressed: the story is the hook, the shift is the illumination, relating it back is the mechanism, and the CTA is the transfer.

FIG. 12 — ORGANIC TESTING DECIDES WHERE MONEY GOES



↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 14

14 SHIFTCYCLE WEEKLY PLANNER

EVERY WEEK

One theme, five daily pieces. Short form is written specifically — never cut from long form.

THIS WEEK'S SHIFT THEME

LONG-FORM PIECE IT CONNECTS TO

◆ WORKED EXAMPLE — KEYSTONE BASEMENT SYSTEMS

MONDAY · SIGNAL

"Everybody in this town blames the gutters. Here is what I found under a driveway on Tuesday." — 38 seconds, phone, no edit.

MONDAY · SIGNAL — CURIOSITY

The piece

TUESDAY · TENSION — FRUSTRATION

The piece

WEDNESDAY · PROOF — HOPE

The piece

THURSDAY · PERSPECTIVE — CONVICTION

The piece

FRIDAY · PATH — MOMENTUM

The piece

W20 BUILD THE AD SEQUENCE

PHASE 04

Distribution is where the library stops being a cost and starts being a machine.

THE LESSON

- Each core video runs as its own always-on ad at $5–10 a day.
- Anyone who watches roughly 25% advances to the next video and joins the audience.
- Every per-video audience rolls into one master list — the Full List. That list is the actual asset.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Set up the ad account, pixel, and per-video custom audiences.
- [ ] Build the sequence: video one to cold, 25% viewers to video two, and so on.
- [ ] Create the Full List as a combined audience of every qualified viewer.
- [ ] Set budgets and turn the first three videos on.

DELIVERABLE

A live sequence with per-video audiences and one combined Full List.

DONE WHEN

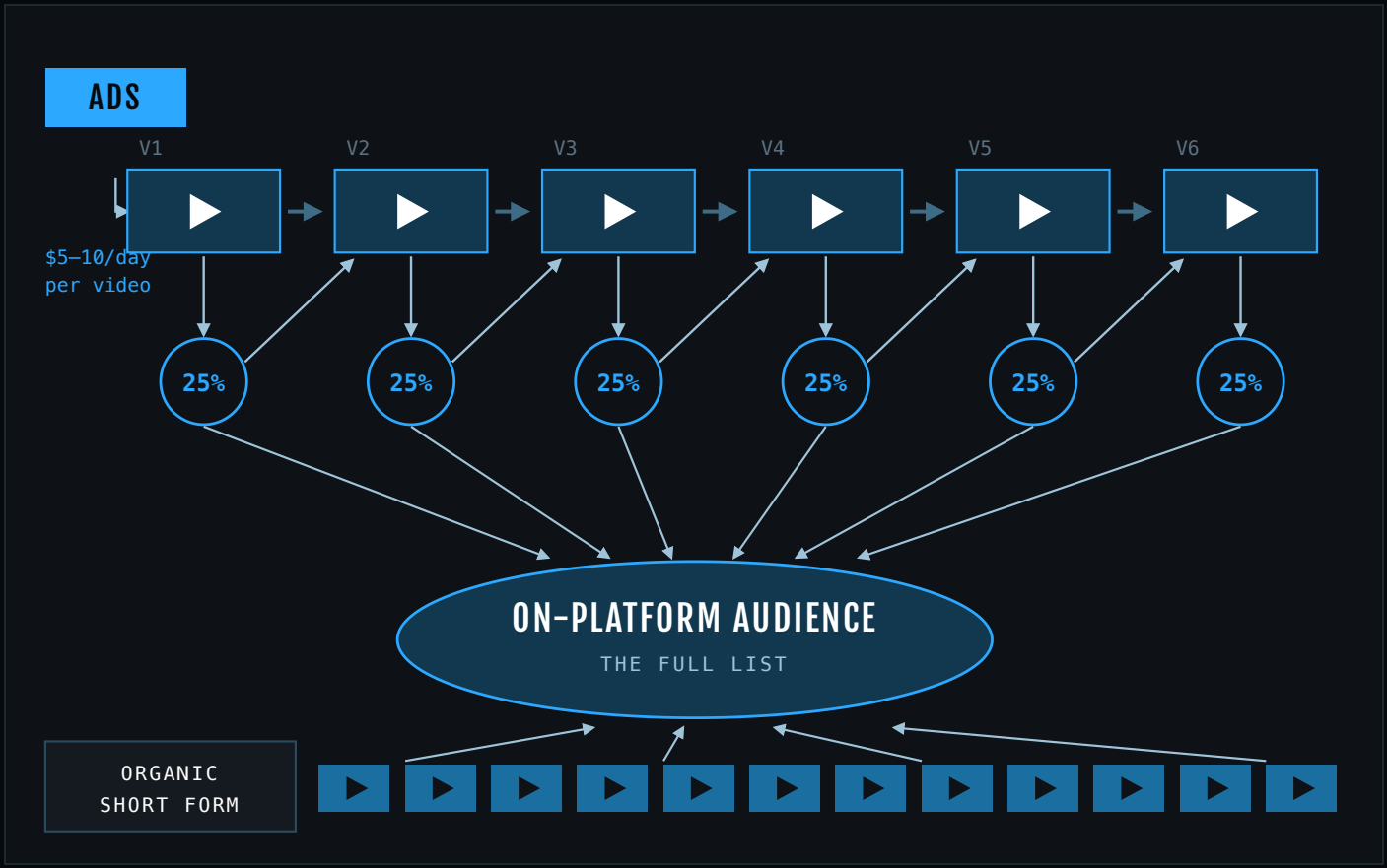
A stranger can enter at video one and be walked through the library automatically.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *What is your Full List size today? That number is the one to watch for the next year.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Optimizing for leads or clicks. Optimize for watch-through; the exposure is the point.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 11 — PAID SEQUENCE & AUDIENCE BUILD



Each sequenced video runs as its own always-on ad. Watch 25% and you advance to the next one and join the Full List. The six shown here are a subset of the 25-video library, not all of it. Daily organic short form feeds the same pool from below.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 15

15 SEQUENCE + AUDIENCE MAP

W20

The distribution wiring. Fill this in as you build the ad account, not from memory afterwards.

DAILY BUDGET PER CORE VIDEO

$5–10

WATCH THRESHOLD THAT ADVANCES A VIEWER

~25%

STEP 1	Video	Audience it is served to
STEP 2	Video	Audience it is served to
STEP 3	Video	Audience it is served to
STEP 4	Video	Audience it is served to
STEP 5	Video	Audience it is served to
STEP 6	Video	Audience it is served to

FULL LIST — COMBINED AUDIENCE NAME

FULL LIST SIZE ON THE DAY IT WENT LIVE

W21 MAGNETS, CTAS, AND THE DM PLAYBOOK

PHASE 04

Both calls to action land in the same place: a conversation.

THE LESSON

- First CTA is low friction — a shift magnet, a free resource whose job is to shift a belief, not just capture an email.
- Second CTA is for people ready now — the VSL.
- Both route to DMs, because sales happen in conversation once trust already exists.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Build one shift magnet tied directly to your Core Belief.
- [ ] Add both CTAs to every published video and to the daily content template.
- [ ] Write the DM playbook: opener, qualifying questions, and how a conversation becomes a booking.
- [ ] Name who answers DMs and how fast.

DELIVERABLE

One shift magnet live, both CTAs on every asset, and a written DM playbook with an owner.

DONE WHEN

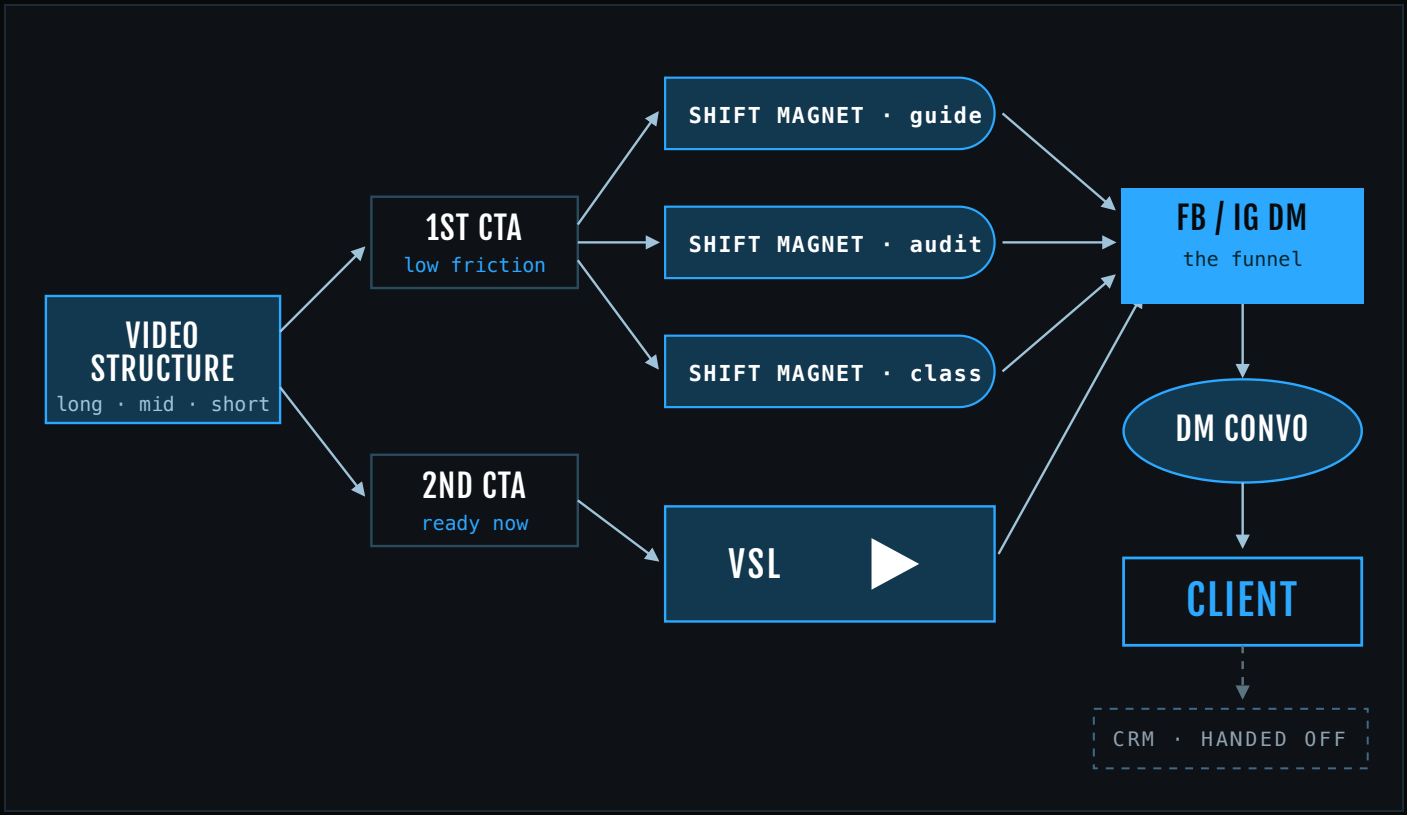
A DM arriving at 9pm gets a real answer by the next morning, using the playbook.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *What belief does your magnet shift? If the answer is "none, it is just useful", rebuild it.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Three magnets and no owner for DMs. One magnet answered fast beats three ignored.

REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 13 — FROM VIDEO TO REVENUE



A **shift magnet** is a free resource whose job is to shift a belief, not just capture an email. Both CTAs land in the same place: a conversation. Closed clients hand off to whatever CRM you already run — that's where tracking and follow-up live.

FIG. 14 — THE DM MATRIX

STAGE	FUNCTION	THEIR QUESTION	ASSET	RESULT
S SIGNAL THE CONNECTION™	Re-establish context and relevance	*Why are you messaging me?*	Reminder tied to their action	RECOGNITION
H HIGHLIGHT THE CONSTRAINT™	Diagnose the immediate problem	*Which problem is mine?*	Three-option diagnostic	IDENTIFICATION
I ILLUMINATE THE ISSUE™	Reveal the deeper cause	*What is actually causing this?*	Insight plus one context question	TRUST
F FORM THE NEXT STEP™	Deliver guidance and the promised resource	*What should I do first?*	Tailored recommendation	VALUE
T TRIGGER THE TRANSFER™	Move toward the broader solution	*What is the logical next action?*	Offer doc, video, or invitation	MOMENTUM

FIG. 15 — THE RE-ENGAGEMENT LOOP

LEVEL 1	**CONTEXT NUDGE**	*Hey [First name], did you get a chance to look at the [Resource]?*
LEVEL 2	**FRICTION NUDGE**	*Was there anything in it that didn't fit your situation?*
LEVEL 3	**OUTCOME NUDGE**	*Is solving [Specific problem] still a priority right now?*
LEVEL 4	**PERMISSION TO CLOSE**	*Should I close the loop on this for now?*

> Never send "just following up" twice. Each level references the unresolved decision instead of your own patience. Use loss aversion carefully — the goal is clarity, not guilt.

FIG. 16 — THE DM BUILDER: FILL THIS IN ONCE PER OFFER

S SIGNAL

PROSPECT ACTION

RESOURCE REQUESTED

OPENING LINE

H HIGHLIGHT

SCENARIO A

SCENARIO B

SCENARIO C

I ILLUMINATE

COMMON FAILED APPROACH

HIDDEN CAUSE

ONE CONTEXT QUESTION

F FORM

IMMEDIATE RECOMMENDATION

RESOURCE

CONTAINED PROBLEM IT SOLVES

T TRIGGER

NEXT LOGICAL BOTTLENECK

LARGER PROBLEM

NEXT ASSET OR ACTION

↓ WORKSHEETS FOR THIS WEEK — MODULES 16 · 17

16 SHIFT MAGNET BUILDER

W21

A magnet whose job is to shift a belief, not capture an email. If it does not change what someone thinks, rebuild it.

WORKING TITLE

VERSION

SPECIFIC AUDIENCE

Not

TRIGGERING PROBLEM

What they just experienced that makes them want this

THE PROMISE — ONE SENTENCE

THE BELIEF IT SHIFTS

COMPLETION TIME

Under 10 minutes is the target

DELIVERY FORMAT

PDF / checklist / video / audit

SECTIONS OR STEPS

THE IMMEDIATE WIN — WHAT THEY GET IN THE FIRST TWO MINUTES

THE BRIDGE TO THE OFFER

HOSTED WHERE

DELIVERY AUTOMATION

TRACKING LINK

THANK-YOU MESSAGE + DM HANDOFF

17 DM PLAYBOOK

W21 · REFERENCE + ONE PER CONVERSATION

A playbook is not complete until it handles silence, objections, and routing. The top half is written once; the bottom half is per conversation.

WRITTEN ONCE

OPENER — FIRST REPLY TO AN INBOUND DM

A / B / C DIAGNOSTIC — THE THREE QUESTIONS THAT SORT EVERY INBOUND

HOW A CONVERSATION BECOMES A BOOKING

WHO ANSWERS DMS

PROMISED RESPONSE TIME

RE-ENGAGEMENT LADDER — FOUR MESSAGES FOR SILENCE

DAY 2 — LIGHT, NO ASK

DAY 5 — NEW VALUE, NO ASK

DAY 12 — DIRECT QUESTION

DAY 30 — CLOSE THE LOOP HONESTLY

PER CONVERSATION

TRIGGER / SOURCE

Which video, magnet, or post

CONSTRAINT IDENTIFIED

FAILED WORKAROUND THEY ALREADY TRIED

KEY METRIC THEY CARE ABOUT

RESOURCE SENT

RECOMMENDATION MADE

BOOKING INVITED?

OBJECTION RAISED — VERBATIM

FOLLOW-UP DATE

OUTCOME

IF LOST — REASON

LEARNING FED BACK INTO THE MESSAGING PAGE

W22 READ THE NUMBERS

◆ PHASE GATE

The machine is now running. This week is about learning to judge it correctly.

THE LESSON

- Report on watch time, average view duration, how many clear each 25% gate, Full List growth, and DM conversations started.
- Do not report on leads yet. It is too early and it will make you change the wrong thing.
- Organic performance decides where ad money goes: only posts that win organically get spend.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Build a one-page monthly dashboard with those five numbers.
- [ ] Identify your two or three best-performing organic posts and put budget behind them, aimed at the Full List.
- [ ] Find the video with the worst drop-off in the first fifteen seconds and rewrite its opening.
- [ ] Review the sequence: is anyone reaching video four yet?

DELIVERABLE

A monthly dashboard and the first round of promoted organic winners.

DONE WHEN

You can answer "is this working?" with attention data instead of opinion.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *Which video has the highest average view duration? Make three more like it.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Killing the system because leads have not appeared. Month four is early; the benchmark is seven hours.

↓ WORKSHEETS FOR THIS WEEK — MODULES 21 · 22

21 METRIC DICTIONARY

REFERENCE

Agree these definitions once. Five people counting "DM conversations" five ways produces a dashboard nobody trusts.

METRIC	DEFINITION	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER
WATCH TIME	Total minutes of your content consumed, all platforms	Platform analytics	Monthly	Operator
AVG. VIEW DURATION	Watch time ÷ views, compared within format only	Platform analytics	Monthly	Operator
GATE CLEARANCE	Viewers hitting 25% ÷ video starts, per sequence step	Ad platform	Weekly	Media buyer
FULL LIST SIZE	Deduplicated count of everyone who cleared any gate	Ad platform	Monthly	Media buyer
DM CONVERSATIONS	Inbound threads with at least one reply from the prospect	Inbox / CRM	Weekly	DM owner
EVENT ATTENDANCE	Live attendees ÷ registrations	Event platform	Monthly	Event host

> Leads and cost per lead are deliberately absent until month five. Adding them early makes you change the wrong thing.

22 MONTHLY DASHBOARD

MONTHLY

Numbers, then the decision they produced. A row with no decision was not worth collecting.

MONTH

WATCH TIME

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

AVERAGE VIEW DURATION

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

GATE CLEARANCE

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

FULL LIST SIZE

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

DM CONVERSATIONS

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

EVENT ATTENDANCE

Baseline	Target	Actual

Interpretation → decision made → owner → due

BEST ORGANIC POST THIS MONTH — AND WHY

PROMOTED TO THE FULL LIST?

PHASE 05 W23–W26

CONVERSION

TURNING ATTENTION INTO CLIENTS

The monthly event, the offer doc, and the loop that never ends.

W23 DESIGN THE MONTHLY WORKSHOP

PHASE 05

The event is what converts a warm list into conversations. One framework runs every workshop you will ever hold.

THE LESSON

- Surface the Struggle — recognition. Highlight the Horizon — hope. Illuminate the Insight — clarity. Form the Solution — capability. Transfer the Transformation — momentum.
- Teach only the three to five concepts needed to produce the outcome.
- Do not explain the work; have participants complete the work in the room.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Choose one topic and design the workshop against the five stages.
- [ ] Build the worksheet or template participants will actually complete live.
- [ ] Decide free or paid, and the platform.
- [ ] Set the date and the following two months' dates at the same time.

DELIVERABLE

A designed workshop with a completion asset, and three dates on the calendar.

DONE WHEN

A participant would leave with something finished, not just notes.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *What could someone build in sixty minutes that would make hiring you the obvious next step?*

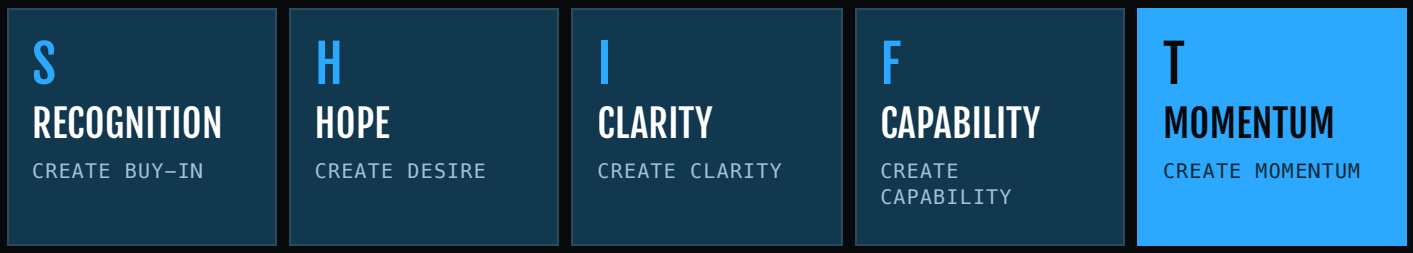
WHERE IT FAILS · Presenting for an hour. If nobody completed anything, it was a webinar and it will not convert.

▣ REFERENCE FIGURES

FIG. 24 — THE FIVE WORKSHOP STAGES

STAGE	PURPOSE	PARTICIPANT QUESTION	DELIVERABLE
S SURFACE THE STRUGGLE™	Create emotional buy-in by making the problem feel real and urgent.	*Why does this matter to me?*	RECOGNITION
H HIGHLIGHT THE HORIZON™	Paint the desired future and establish what is possible.	*What could my life or business look like?*	HOPE
I ILLUMINATE THE INSIGHT™	Install the key beliefs, frameworks, and mental models.	*What do I need to understand differently?*	CLARITY
F FORM THE SOLUTION™	Guide participants through building or implementing the solution.	*How do I actually do this?*	CAPABILITY
T TRANSFER THE TRANSFORMATION™	Turn learning into action with completed work and a clear next step.	*What do I do next?*	MOMENTUM

FIG. 25 — THE TRANSFORMATION SEQUENCE



> Recognition → Hope → Clarity → Capability → Momentum. If participants leave without a completed asset and one action they can take in under two minutes, the workshop stopped at Clarity.

FIG. 23 — THE MONTHLY CADENCE

WEEKS 1–2
ANNOUNCE
Promote to the Full List and in every video CTA. Registration is the only ask.

WEEK 3
RUN IT LIVE
Teach one topic properly, take live questions, name names.

END OF EVENT
INVITE
Point everyone to the offer doc: what it is, who it's for, what happens next.

WEEK 4
FOLLOW UP
Replay to no-shows, conversations with attendees. Then reset for next month.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 19

19 WORKSHOP DESIGNER

W23 · MONTHLY

Every workshop runs the same five stages. The topic changes; the sequence never does.

WORKSHOP TITLE

DATE

FREE OR PAID

PLATFORM

S · SURFACE THE STRUGGLE — RECOGNITION

H · HIGHLIGHT THE HORIZON — HOPE

I · ILLUMINATE THE INSIGHT — CLARITY (3–5 CONCEPTS ONLY)

F · FORM THE SOLUTION — CAPABILITY (WHAT THEY BUILD LIVE)

T · TRANSFER THE TRANSFORMATION — MOMENTUM (THE INVITATION)

THE COMPLETION ASSET PARTICIPANTS LEAVE WITH

> If nobody completed anything, it was a webinar and it will not convert.

W24 WRITE THE OFFER DOC

PHASE 05

The workshop ends with one invitation, and that invitation needs somewhere to point.

THE LESSON

- One page: the offer, the outcome, who it fits, the price if there is one, and how to start.
- It can be free — a diagnostic, an audit, a plan — or paid.
- Its only job is to make the next step obvious and easy to say yes to.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Write the offer doc on one page.
- [ ] Remove every sentence that is about you rather than about their next step.
- [ ] Test it on someone who attended nothing — can they tell you what to do next?
- [ ] Wire it into the workshop close, the VSL, and the DM playbook.

DELIVERABLE
A one-page offer doc, linked from the event, the VSL, and DMs.

DONE WHEN
A stranger reading it knows what they get, what it costs, and what to do in the next five minutes.

> COACHING PROMPT
> *Is the next step small enough that saying yes costs almost nothing?*

WHERE IT FAILS · A page full of features. It is a doorway, not a brochure.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 20

20 OFFER DOCUMENT BUILDER

W24

Deep enough to close on. Every sentence is about their next step, not about you.

THE PROBLEM THIS SOLVES — IN THEIR WORDS

THE DESIRED OUTCOME

THE MECHANISM

Your named process from Q7

SCOPE — WHAT IS INCLUDED

DELIVERABLES — WHAT THEY PHYSICALLY RECEIVE

TIMELINE

RESPONSIBILITIES — YOURS AND THEIRS

PROOF — THE STRONGEST EVIDENCE, UP FRONT

PRICE

PAYMENT TERMS

RISK REVERSAL — WHAT YOU CARRY SO THEY DO NOT

EXCLUSIONS — WHAT THIS IS NOT

QUALIFICATION CRITERIA — WHO THIS IS NOT FOR

FAQS — THE THREE QUESTIONS THAT ALWAYS COME

THE NEXT STEP — THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

EXPIRATION OR CAPACITY CONDITION

Only if real

LINKED FROM

Event close / VSL / DM playbook

OFFER DOC — WEAK / ACCEPTABLE / STRONG

CRITERION	WEAK	ACCEPTABLE	STRONG
FOCUS	About your company	About the service	About their next step
SCOPE	Vague	Listed	Listed with what is excluded
RISK	All on the buyer	Guarantee mentioned	A guarantee that costs you something if invoked
QUALIFICATION	Anyone	Ideal customer described	Explicitly says who should not buy
NEXT STEP	"Contact us"	A booking link	A named action that takes under five minutes

W25 RUN THE FIRST EVENT

PHASE 05

Everything built so far exists to fill this room and make the invitation land.

THE LESSON

- Weeks one and two: announce to the Full List and through every CTA. Registration is the only ask.
- Week three: run it live. Teach properly, take questions, use names.
- Week four: replay to no-shows, conversations with attendees, then reset.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Promote for two full weeks to the Full List and in daily content.
- [ ] Run the workshop and close with the single invitation to the offer doc.
- [ ] Send the replay and open DM conversations with everyone who attended.
- [ ] Record attendance, completion, and conversations started.

DELIVERABLE

One completed event with attendance data and a list of live conversations.

DONE WHEN

Real conversations are happening in DMs with people who watched before they ever spoke to you.

> **COACHING PROMPT**
> *How many attendees had already consumed hours of your content? That is the system working.*

WHERE IT FAILS · Cancelling for low registration. Run it for six people; the recording works for a year.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 23

23 EVENT DEBRIEF

MONTHLY · WITHIN 48 HOURS

Run this while the detail is still sharp.

EVENT DATE

REGISTRATIONS

ATTENDANCE

COMPLETION RATE OF THE LIVE ASSET

DM CONVERSATIONS OPENED

WHAT LANDED

WHAT DRAGGED

ONE CHANGE FOR NEXT MONTH

W26 REVIEW AND SET THE LOOP

PHASE 05

The build is finished. What remains is a rhythm that does not stop, and a quarterly review that keeps it honest.

THE LESSON

- Daily short form, weekly long form, monthly event — permanently.
- The matrix refills once a quarter from the questions customers actually asked.
- The story bank grows continuously; every job is a candidate.

DO THE WORK

- [ ] Compare today's numbers to the week-one audit — minutes available, Full List size, conversations.
- [ ] Refill the matrix with next quarter's five topics.
- [ ] Add every new story collected during production to the bank.
- [ ] Lock the three cadences into the calendar for the next twelve months.

DELIVERABLE

A next-quarter matrix, an updated story bank, and twelve months of cadence booked.

DONE WHEN

The next quarter requires no new decisions — only execution.

> COACHING PROMPT
>
> *What did you learn about your customers this quarter that changes your messaging answers?*

WHERE IT FAILS · Treating the build as finished. The library grows or it decays.

↓ WORKSHEET FOR THIS WEEK — MODULE 24

24 QUARTERLY REVIEW

QUARTERLY

The loop that keeps the system honest. Compare against module 01.

MINUTES OF CONTENT AVAILABLE NOW

vs. module 01

FULL LIST SIZE NOW

CONVERSATIONS THIS QUARTER

WHAT WE LEARNED ABOUT CUSTOMERS THAT CHANGES THE MESSAGING ANSWERS

NEXT QUARTER — FIVE NEW TOPICS

TOPIC 1

TOPIC 2

TOPIC 3

TOPIC 4

TOPIC 5

NEW STORIES ADDED TO THE BANK

CLOSE-OUT

WHAT CHANGED FROM OUR ORIGINAL ASSUMPTION?

WHAT REMAINS UNCLEAR?

WHO OWNS THE NEXT QUARTER

COACH SIGN-OFF + DATE

FIG. 28 — THE WHOLE SYSTEM, BY CADENCE

DAILY MON SIGNAL · TUE TENSION · WED PROOF · THU PERSPECTIVE · FRI PATH	Short form shot for the format	ShiftCycle stage per day	Feeds the Full List
WEEKLY ONE MATRIX VIDEO, SAME DAY, SAME TIME	Long form on YouTube	Story pulled from the bank	Both CTAs attached
MONTHLY ANNOUNCE · RUN · INVITE · FOLLOW UP	One live conversion event	Invitation to the offer doc	DM conversations
QUARTERLY REVIEW, DON'T REBUILD	Re-answer the seven questions	Re-rank the six sequenced videos	Refresh the offer doc

Four rhythms, one direction. Run the top three and the fourth is just maintenance.

AFTER WEEK 26

IT NEVER ENDS, IT JUST GETS EASIER

From here the work is three cadences and one quarterly review. Daily short form. Weekly long form. Monthly event. Refill the matrix every quarter, keep feeding the story bank, and let the Full List compound.

The two things to protect when everything gets busy: the daily post and the monthly event. Everything else can slip a week.